

Kaiyuan Liu

📍 Seattle ✉️ lky04@cs.washington.edu 🔗 kaiyuanliu04.github.io 🎓 Scholar in Kaiyuan Liu

Education

B.S. University of Washington, Seattle	2022 ~2026
Double Major: Computer Science, Mathematics	
- GPA: 3.93/4.0; Honor Math Sequence; Deans List - Departmental Honors in Computer Science	

Awards

ICPC World Final Honor , ICPC Foundation	2024.09
CRA Undergraduate Research Award Honorable Mention , CRA	2025.09
Shenoy Undergraduate Research Fellowship , Simons Foundation	2024 ~2025
CSE Award for Excellence Scholarship , University of Washington	2024 ~2025
ICPC North American Championship 12th Place , ICPC Foundation	2024.05
UW Winter Programming Contest Champion , University of Washington	2023 ~2024
Tinker Research Grant , 5000\$ credit, Thinking Machines Lab	2025.11

Publications

LiveCodeBench Pro: How Do Olympiad Medalists Judge LLMs in Competitive Programming?

Zihan Zheng*, Zerui Cheng*, Zeyu Shen*, Shang Zhou*, **Kaiyuan Liu***, *et al.* *Equal contribution
The Thirty-Ninth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2025)
arxiv.org/abs/2506.11928 🔗

AutoCode: LLMs as Problem Setters for Competitive Programming

Shang Zhou*, Zihan Zheng*, **Kaiyuan Liu***, *et al.* *Equal contribution
arxiv.org/abs/2510.12803 🔗
 The Fourteenth International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2026)

Evaluating LLM Agents as Human Simulators in Climate Social Dilemmas

Kaiyuan Liu*, Xiaoxuan Hou*, Jiayi Yuan, Natasha Jaques *Equal contribution
[Preview Link](#) 🔗
 Under Review at *ACL 2026*

FrontierCS: Evolving Challenges for Evolving Intelligence

Qiuyang Mang*, Wenhao Chai*, Zhifei Li*, Huanzhi Mao*, Shang Zhou*, *et al.* *Equal contribution
arxiv.org/abs/2512.15699 🔗
 Under Review at *ICML 2026*

Experience

Social RL Lab , Research Assistant	Seattle, WA
- Working on various projects related to multi-agent, reinforcement learning, and large language models. - Mentored by Dr. Natasha Jaques.	2025.01 ~Present
Allen Institute , Research Assistant	Seattle, WA
Applied Deep Learning and Reinforcement Learning to analyze representations from artificial models and neural data from Multi-Armed Bandit mouse foraging tasks. Explored brain representations and dynamics in decision making	2024.09 ~2025.05

VecML, Machine Learning Engineer

- VecML is a startup company focusing on Machine Learning System Infrastructure.
- Tested and developed vector databases for Retrieval-Augmented Generation.
- Designed and implemented an Memory-Disk Hybrid Architecture for fast Top-K Nearest Neighborhood Search

Seattle, WA
2024.06 ~2024.09

University of Washington, Teaching Assistant

- Assisted in undergraduate algorithm courses for both major (CSE 421) and non-major (CSE 417) students.
- Served as leading TA in CSE 421 2024 Winter.

Seattle, WA
2023 ~2024

Professional Service

Reviewer, NeurIPS Workshop 2025, AAAI 2026, AAMAS 2026

ICPC Coach, University of Washington ICPC 2026

Projects

Neural Translator: Predicting Neural Activity from Other Brain Regions

Comp Neuro, NLP

- Developed a neural translator model that predicts neural activity in one brain region from activity patterns in other regions using deep learning and sequence-modeling techniques.

Neural Spike Vectorization with Attention

RL, NLP, Comp Neuro

- Developed an attention-based model for vectorizing brain spike sequences.
- Compared latent representations of RL-trained RNNs with vectorized neural activity from mice performing decision-making tasks using optimal-transport metrics.

Fine-grained Chinese Toxic Language Detection

NLP

- Reimplemented and improved Chinese toxic language classifier based on BERT
- Authored technical poster and report

Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning Survey

RL

- Conducted literature review on MARL algorithms, especially in games.

Variational Autoencoder for Neural Data

DL

- Implemented VAE model for analyzing high-dimensional neural data

Technologies

Languages: Python, PyTorch, JAX, C++, Java, TypeScript, $\LaTeX$

Databases: MySQL, NoSQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite, Azure

Topics: Algorithm Design, Reinforcement Learning, Machine Learning, NLP, Computational Neuroscience

Languages: English, Chinese (Mandarin)